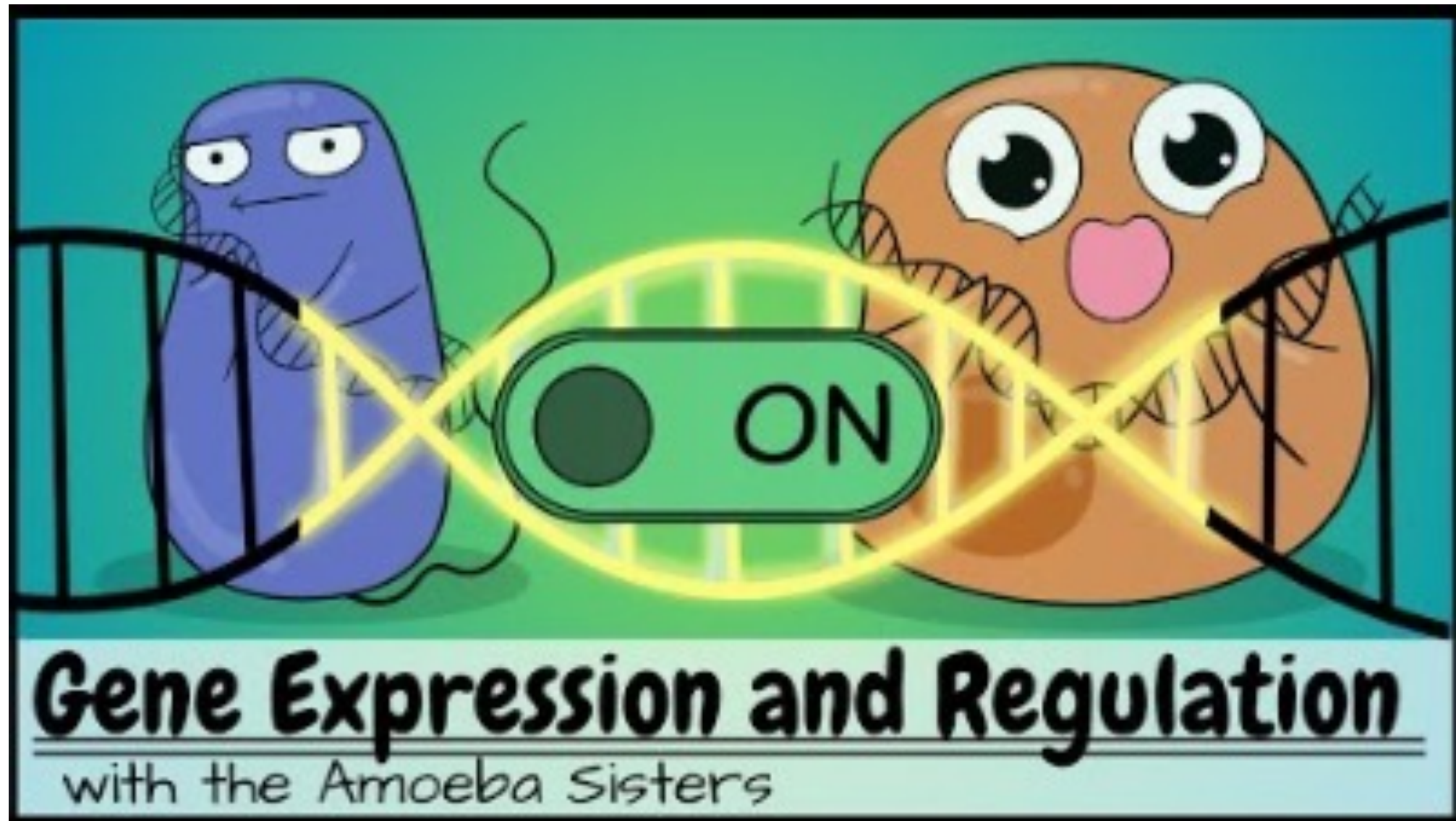




<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ebIpkw3XapE>

Control in living systems

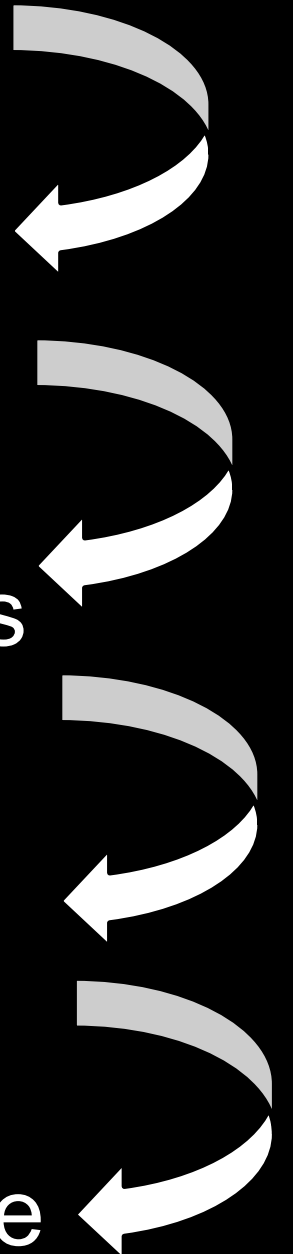
Gene expression

control of cell division

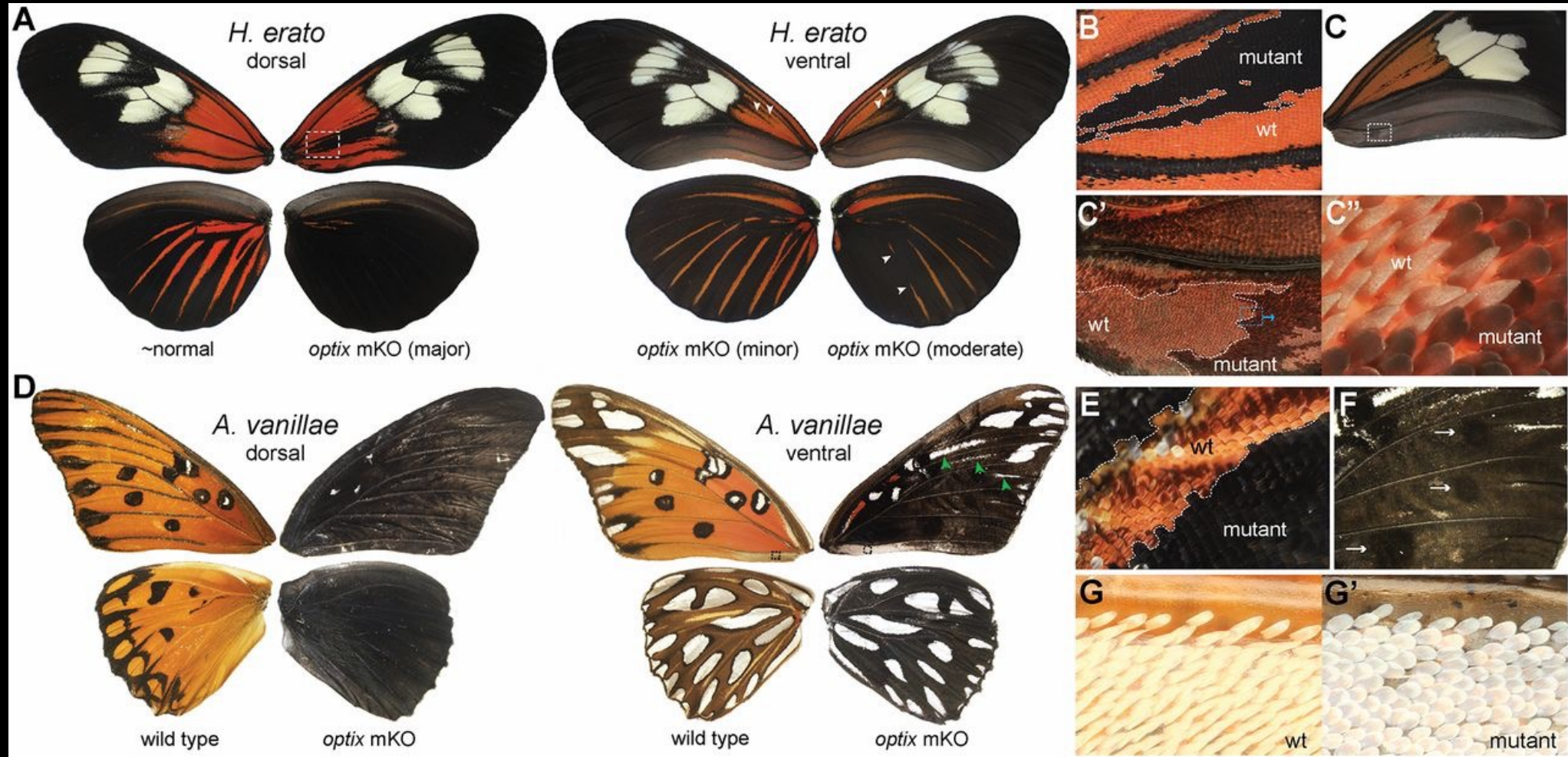
Hormones, signals & receptors

feedback control

control failure & disease



What do you see here??



<https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1709058114>

Gene expression

Information encoded in a gene is turned into a function.

on/off switch” to control when and where RNA molecules and proteins are made and as a “volume control” to determine how much of those products are made.

carefully regulated, changing substantially under different conditions and cell types.

The RNA and protein products of many genes serve to regulate the expression of other genes.

Where, when, and how much a gene is expressed can also be assessed by measuring the functional activity of a gene product or observing a phenotype associated with a gene.

The DNA strand that corresponds to the mRNA is called the coding or sense strand.

Gene expression

Operon – grouped genes that are transcribed together – code for functionally similar proteins

Promoter – section of DNA where RNA polymerase binds

Operator – Controls activation of transcription

- on/off switch
- between promoter and genes for proteins – structural genes

Repressor protein – binds to operator to block RNA polymerase and shut down transcription

- Turns off the operon

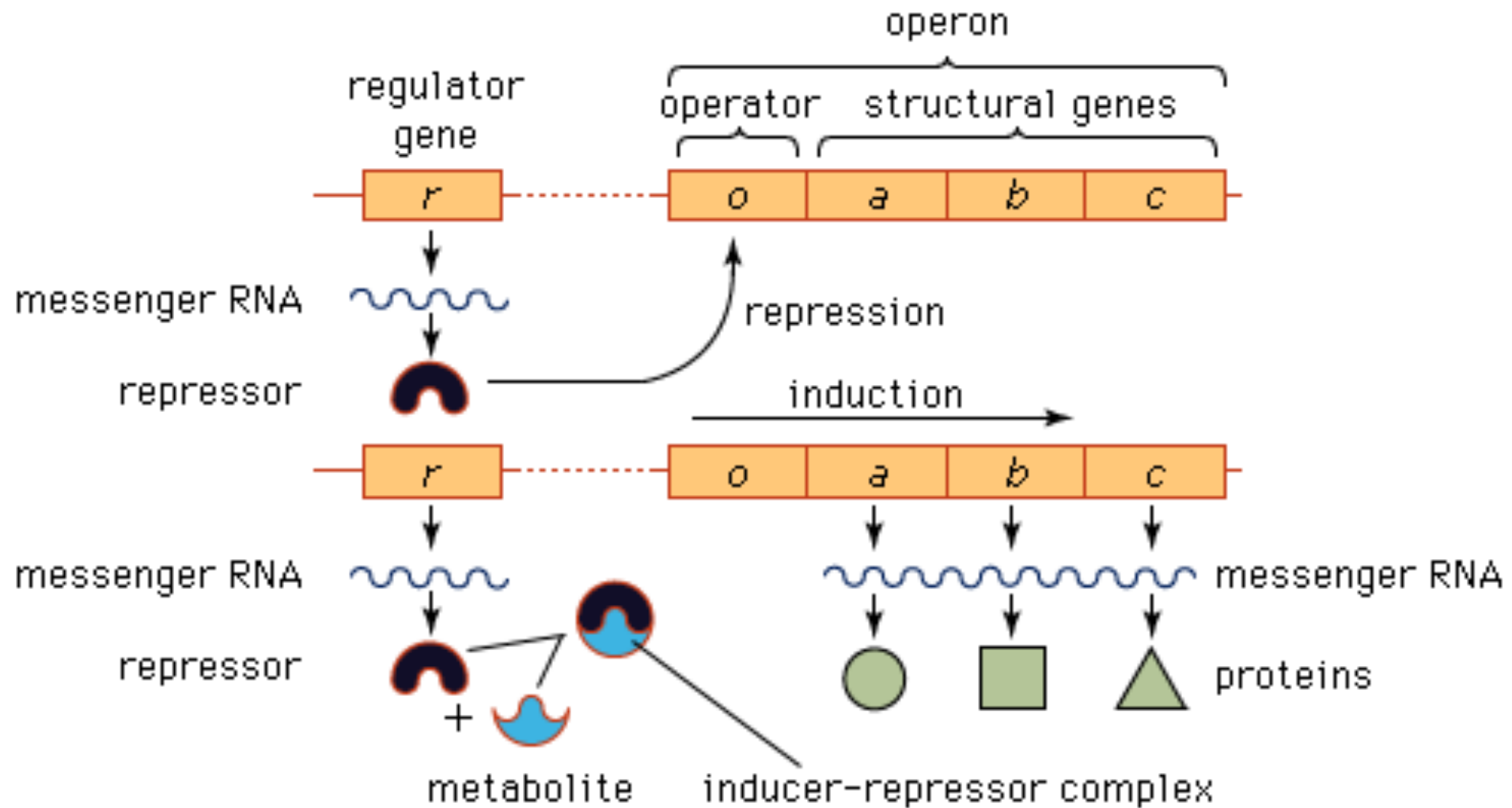
Corepressor – keeps the repressor protein on the operator (Trp operon)

Inducer – pulls repressor off the operator

- Turns on the operon – lactose on the lac operon

Regulatory gene – produces the repressor protein

Structural genes – code for proteins



Lac Operon

Gene z: Galactosidase

Lactose- Glucose

Gene y: Permease

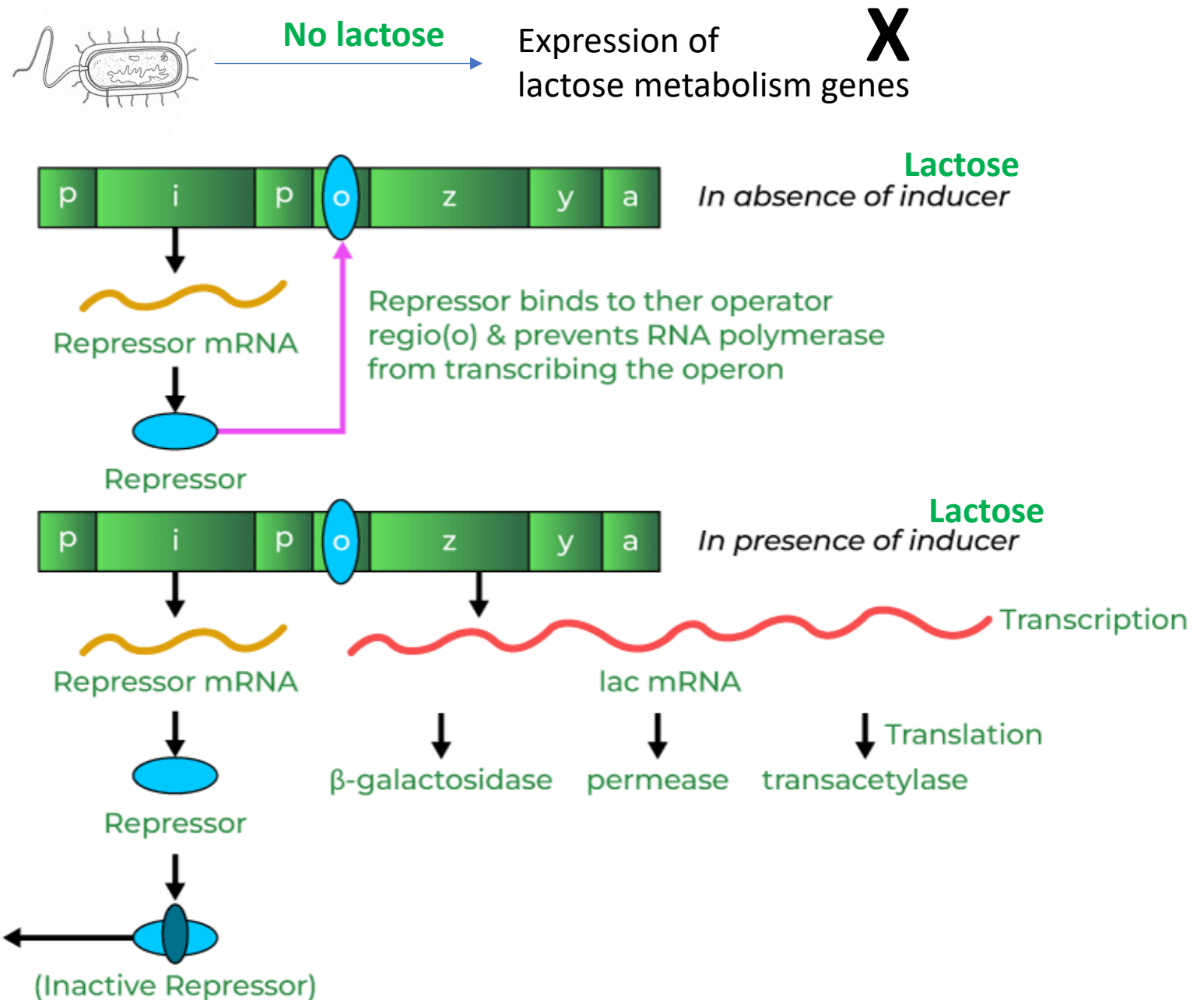
Lactose crossing membrane

Gene a: Transacetylase

Helps Galactosidase



Lactose



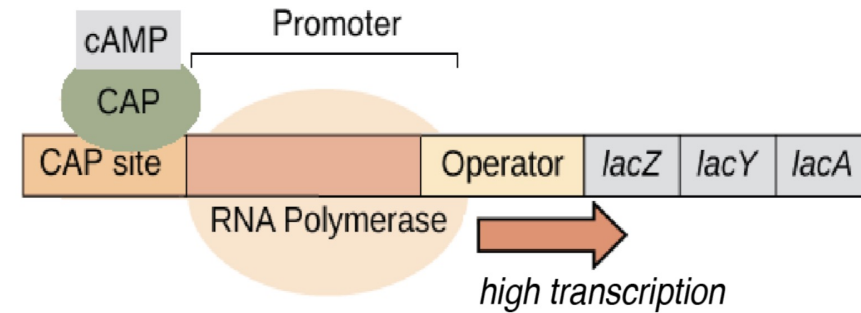
Does the gene expression occur at a constant rate?

No!

- **Catabolite activator protein (CAP)** is a positive regulator
- Low glucose (Hunger Signal) cAMP enables CAP and DNA binding
- CAP increases the rate of gene expression

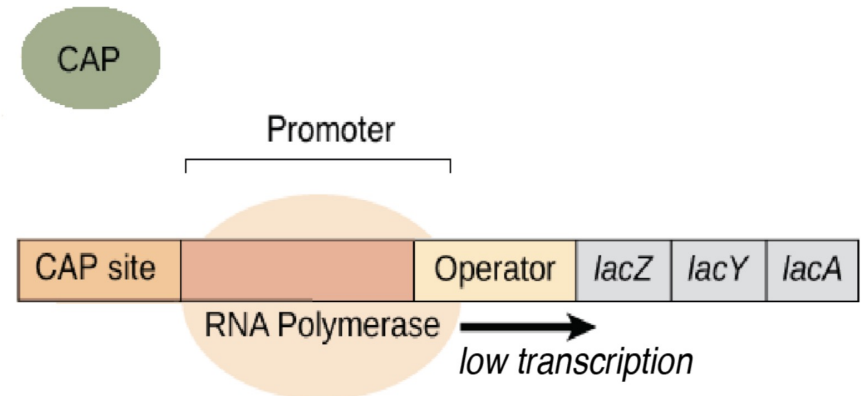
Low glucose:

When glucose levels are low, cAMP is produced. The cAMP attaches to CAP, allowing it to bind DNA. CAP helps RNA polymerase bind to the promoter, resulting in high levels of transcription.

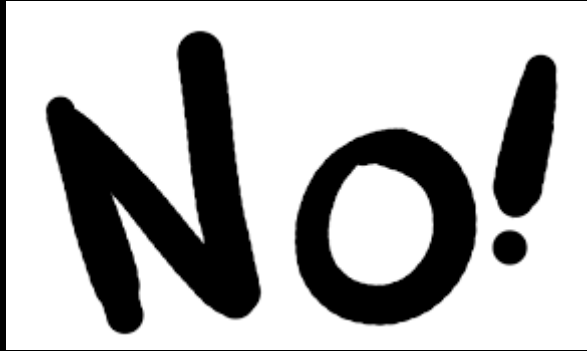


High glucose:

When glucose levels are high, no cAMP is made. CAP cannot bind DNA without cAMP, so transcription occurs only at a low level.



Does all the DNA gets transcribed?



No!

Only certain sections of the DNA are made (transcribed) into message (mRNA)

AND...only part of the mRNA is actually used and sent out of the nucleus to meet up with a ribosome!

This is EDITING!!

How is mRNA Edited?

On a mRNA strand there are areas called: Exons and Introns

Introns are cut out before leaving the nucleus

Exons are left, and this shortened piece of mRNA leaves the nucleus and gets Translated into Proteins

RNA Processing Regulation

Alternative RNA Splicing – different regions of the pre-mRNA serve as introns or exons creating different mRNA strands depending on what is removed & spliced together

